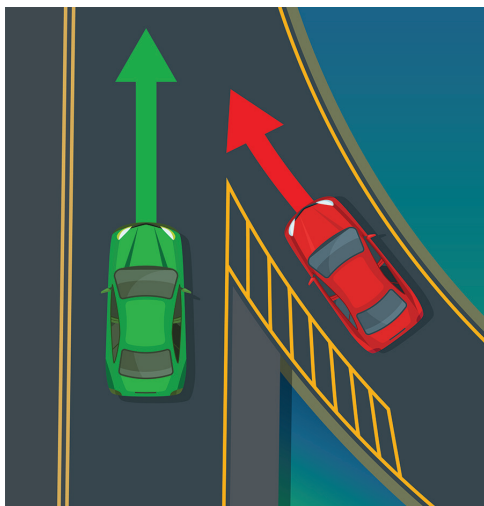


5.3 | MERGING

When you're merging, enter traffic with enough space so you don't cause the people around you to swerve, slow, or stop. Trying to merge into a space that is too small can be dangerous, especially if the driver in front needs to stop or slow down.



Drivers already on the interstate have the right-of-way, so creating space to merge might require you to adjust your speed, faster or slower. Use the entire on-ramp, your turn signal, and your mirrors to merge into a safe space on the interstate.

ZIPPER MERGING

When traffic is moving slowly or is stopped due to a lane closure, it's important to merge smoothly and efficiently. Zipper merging is a technique that:

- Improves traffic flow by 60 percent.
- Creates a predictable merging pattern, reducing the risk of collisions caused by sudden lane changes.
- Helps avoid the frustration of long lines and the temptation to cut in line.

How to zipper merge:

- **Stay in your lane.** Continue using both lanes until you reach the designated merge area.

